

# Romain Sickenberg

## Backend-Software Engineer

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Backend Software Engineer with **5+ years** building and maintaining business-critical web applications and **REST APIs** with **PHP**, **Symfony**, **Laravel**, **React** and **Docker**.

Hands-on across application design, component integration and deployment (**CI/CD**), including code review, production releases and technical leadership of medium-sized projects.

Work authorization: Swiss Citizen. Available now.

## Experience

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### Full-Stack Software Developer

03.2024 - 12.2025

#### Academic Work SA

IT Consulting for diverse clients via Academic Work.

- Designed a decoupled backend/frontend architecture for SIL Lausanne and built the **Docker** base platform underpinning most of their in-house solutions (**Python**, **Django**, **Vue**, **React**).
  - Shipped a **React (Next.js)** application with **GitHub Actions CI/CD**, **Docker** containerization and automated deployments to Jelastic.
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### Backend Software Engineer

10.2021 - 02.2023

#### Antistatique SA

From Junior to mid-level Software Engineer & highest skill jump!

- Built and maintained enterprise **Symfony 6** applications and their **REST APIs (API Platform)**, on **PHP 7.4/8.0** with **Doctrine ORM**, **PostgreSQL**, **Redis** caching and **Elasticsearch** indexing.
  - Led a five-developer team as **PHP Lead Developer** on a 3-4 month **Symfony** build for Colis du Coeur, shipping v1 of a state-machine-driven workflow for volunteer distribution centres.
  - Delivered and maintained six CMS builds - five **Drupal**, one **WordPress**.
  - Cut **GitHub Actions** execution time by **75%** through dependency caching and workflow optimization.
  - Led code reviews and owned technical delivery on small to medium-sized projects, including a client platform hosted on **AWS**, enforcing maintainability and development standards.
  - Built a small internal tool on a **serverless Firebase** backend with a **Vue.js** front end.
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### Junior Backend Software Engineer

02.2021 - 10.2021

#### Ilem Group

IT Consulting to an external client named Berdoz Vision & Audition.

- Secured and migrated a business-critical ERP serving **20 retail stores** to a newer **PHP** version, then helped build its **Laravel** replacement.
  - Configured a fleet of **44 iPads** and set up CI servers running **Codeception** and **Cypress** test suites.
  - Hardened security and developed critical components of the in-house CRM used across that same 20-store network.
  - Built internal tooling for automated testing, monitoring and deployment, with **Sentry** for error tracking.
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### Apprentice Software Engineer

06.2016 - 06.2020

#### Liip AG

- Developed and extended internal web applications in **PHP** and **JavaScript**.
- Shipped features in an **Agile** team using **Git**, **Scrum** and modern web development practices.
- Developed custom **Moodle** plugins with **PHP 5.4**.

## Personal Breaks & Side Activities

- Security agent at Securitas AG - part-time, event sector. 07.2023 - 03.2024
- Planned career break - solo world travel and personal development. 02.2023 - 06.2023
- Swiss Armed Forces - mandatory military service. 07.2020 - 11.2020

## Skills

### Backend

PHP, Python, Node.js, C#,  
Java, REST APIs

### Databases

PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB,  
Prisma / Supabase, Redis,  
Elasticsearch

### Tools

Git, GitLab, Composer,  
Jira, Confluence & Scrum,  
Sentry, Bash

### Cloud & DevOps

Docker, GitHub Actions,  
CI/CD, Linux,  
Apache & Nginx, AWS,  
Google Cloud Platform (GCP),  
Firebase, Serverless

### Frontend

TypeScript & JavaScript,  
React, Next.js, Nuxt.js,  
NPM & Bun,  
HTML5 & CSS, Sass,  
Tailwind CSS, Alpine.js

### Mobile

Swift 5, iOS, WatchOS,  
Combine, Intents, Swift UI

## Education

Swiss Confederation | EPSIC @ Lausanne & CFPT @ Geneva 08.2016 - 07.2020  
Federal VET Diploma in Information Technology (CFC)  
GPA: 4.4

## Projects

Tesla Companion 01.2018 - 01.2023  
Paid **iOS** & **WatchOS** App to work around Tesla cars.  

- Built and published a commercial **iOS** and **watchOS** application integrating **Tesla APIs** reaching over **1,000 daily active users** and ranking **#5** in the App Store Trips category.

Fort-To-Nite 01.2017 - 01.2019  
Free **iOS** wiki around Fortnite with live in-game shop indications and **Django** back-end.  

- Fortnite companion app with **100,000+ downloads**, **4.6/5.0★ rating (340+ reviews)** and a peak ranking of **#19** in the App Store Reference category.

## Awards

EPFL Hackathon AR/VR Game Experiences 12.2019 - 12.2019  
RA \ VR Hackathon  
Built a "digital museum" in Virtual reality. Won the **first place** in VR experiences, built with **SteamVR** and **Unity**.

## Languages

**French:** Native (C2) · **English:** Fluent (C2) · **German:** Intermediate (B1)